

As I Was Saying

BOB INGRAM

SPORTS EDITOR

Week's Big Events

THE GREAT DOBBS DECISION overshadowed opening of the big leagues so much here this week that about all I could get out of the latter was that Sandy Koufax had a tired arm, not tired blood, and that Whitey Ford wasn't permitted to carry a hot water bottle in his hip pocket to warm his pitching fingers. New name for baseball team: Bludgeoneers. Harold Keith, the able sports information director of Oklahoma, gave Nebraska's team that name because of the Huskers' hitting proclivities. What they're doing now: Manolo Fortes, a baseball figure well-known on this part of the border, is managing Fresno in the Mexican Center League. Signs of progress: Ridgelea Country Club of Fort Worth is building an additional 18 holes which will be for men only. El Paso now has a Dobbs and a Dobbins. The latter is Mickey Dobbins, a utility infielder of the Sun Kings, and whatever became of Bennie Dobbins, one-time third baseman of the Texans of the Arizona-Texas League? In the game in which Bobby Dobbs head-coached Army in the absence of Col. Earl (Red) Blaik, the Cadets beat Pennsylvania 35-0. Andy Cohen had a one-shot managing job in the big leagues and directed the Philadelphia Phils to a victory in that game. And did you hear of the touring golfer who was so bad that he was cutoff after the first round instead of at the common cutoff stage at the end of the second 18?

Haskins Backers

THAT ISN'T THE NAME of it but a Don Haskins Club has been formed here. The purpose of it is to keep the Texas Western basketball coach "at any price." The club added to the salary of Haskins and his staff and other athletic officials after the cage season. Will West Point turn to two other Army graduates who are head college coaches now after Dobbs' turndown? They are Bill Yeoman of Houston and John Green of Vanderbilt. Dobbs had a chance to become Army coach once before. That was when Col. "Red" Blaik retired as head coach. Blaik's entire staff was under consideration. Dobbs, then a member, took his name out of the running. He didn't relish the idea then of following a coach who was as successful as Blaik. Joe Garigiola on his radio show this week blasted Paul Dietzel for jumping contracts at L.S.U. and Army. Custom makes those school-coach pacts not worth the paper they're written on when the coach wants to leave. They're meant to protect the coaches, not the schools. The judge who ruled that the Atlanta Braves must come back to Milwaukee or face the consequences may become known as a High Roller. However, judging by the way Atlanta and the National League took the decision, he may be called a Slow Infield Roller.

Two Young Deans

CHUCK TANNER OF THE Sun Kings and Verne Rapp of Arkansas are beginning their second year in the Texas League. Already they are the two deans of the circuit. Week's astute salute to Jackie Warner, the 22-year-old outfielder who has been a smash hit so far this season with the California Angels. Warner spent some time with the Kings last season. He was forced to cut the season short because of a double hernia. Also a salute to Doug Atkins, Sunland Park's six-gun man. Name for pitching staff: Arm Army. Last name of Aubrey Gatewood, pitcher acquired by the Sun Kings from the California Angels, sounds like gateway and he could be just that to a Texas League pennant. Jim Smith, a back-up quarterback for Billy Stevens last season, has not reported for TWC spring practice since the Easter holidays, lending the impression he's quit the squad. Just in is a letter from "The Society for the Preservation of the Crow." This is no joke. It's a group of sportsmen who are appalled at the indiscriminate slaughter of the black crow. The bird might become extinct if this continues. It strikes a responsive chord in a lot of people. They don't want to see the young crows or Old Crow become extinct.

AN EXCITING PLACE

Count the day very dull,
Tain't worth staying around;
When nothing at all's popping
On Texas Western's playground.